

Answer Writing Practice Plan 90-Day Structured Program

From Foundation to Exam-Ready Excellence

UPSCPrepNotes.in • 2026 Edition

Table of Contents

1. Introduction: Why a Structured Plan Matters	3
2. Weeks 1-4: Foundation Phase	4
3. Weeks 5-8: Intermediate Phase	7
4. Weeks 9-12: Advanced Phase	10
5. Model Answers for Each Stage	12
6. Self-Evaluation Template	15
7. Common Mistakes Checklist	17
8. How to Use Feedback Effectively	18
9. Weekly Answer Writing Schedule	19

1. Introduction: Why a Structured Plan Matters

Answer writing is the single most important skill for UPSC Mains. You can know every fact, every committee recommendation, every government scheme — but if you cannot translate that knowledge into a well-structured, time-bound answer, your marks will not reflect your effort. A 90-day structured plan bridges the gap between knowledge acquisition and exam performance.

This plan is designed to take you from zero to exam-ready in 12 weeks. It is built on the principle of progressive complexity — starting with basic structures and short answers, then gradually introducing multi-dimensional analysis, diagrams, time management, and full-paper simulations.

The 90-Day Principle: Improvement in answer writing is not linear. The first 30 days build the foundation, the next 30 days refine technique, and the final 30 days build speed and exam temperament. Do not skip phases — each builds on the previous one.

What You Will Need

- A notebook dedicated solely to answer writing practice (200+ pages)
- Previous years' question papers (2013-2025)
- A timer or stopwatch
- This guide + the IBEC Method guide for structure reference
- A peer or mentor for feedback (optional in Weeks 1-4, essential from Week 5)

The 90-Day Overview

Phase	Weeks	Focus	Answer Length	Daily Time
Foundation	1-4		150 words (10 marks)	1 hour

		Basic structure, introductions, simple arguments		
Intermediate	5-8	Multi-dimensional analysis, diagrams, evaluation	250 words (15 marks)	1.5 hours
Advanced	9-12	Full papers, time management, peer review	Mix — paper level	2-3 hours

Critical Warning: Do not start writing full-length answers before mastering basic structure. This is the #1 mistake aspirants make — they attempt 250-word answers with complex content in Week 1, get overwhelmed, and give up. Follow the progression. Foundation first, speed later.

2. Weeks 1-4: Foundation Phase

The Foundation Phase is about building the habit of writing and understanding the basic anatomy of a good answer. At this stage, content knowledge is secondary to structure and technique.

Week 1: Understanding Answer Structure

Daily Targets

- **Day 1:** Read 3 topper copies for any GS paper. Identify the structure — introduction, body, conclusion. Note how many paragraphs, where data is used, how the answer ends.
- **Day 2:** Read the IBEC Method guide thoroughly. Understand the four components and their purposes.
- **Day 3:** Practice writing only introductions — 5 introductions for 5 different questions. Focus on keeping them under 25 words.
- **Day 4:** Practice writing only conclusions — 5 conclusions. Focus on synthesis, not summary.
- **Day 5:** Write 2 complete 150-word answers on any topic from GS1 or GS2. Time yourself: 12 minutes per answer.
- **Day 6:** Review what you wrote on Day 5. Rewrite each answer based on your review.
- **Day 7:** Weekly review — what worked, what didn't. Adjust approach for Week 2.

Week 2: Introduction Techniques Mastery

Day	Focus	Task
8	Factual introductions	Write 4 introductions starting with data/statistics. Verify facts before writing.
9	Contextual introductions	Write 4 introductions linking topic to current events. Use today's newspaper for context.
10	Conceptual introductions	

		Write 4 introductions defining key terms. Pick 4 abstract topics (e.g., justice, federalism, sustainability).
11	Quote-based introductions	Write 4 introductions using quotes. Build a quote bank of 20 quotes from this exercise.
12	Mixed practice	Write 4 introductions — pick the best type for each question, not your favorite type.
13	Full answer practice	Write 2 complete 150-word answers with strong introductions. Time: 12 min each.
14	Review + rewrite	Review Week 2 answers, rewrite 1 answer for perfection.

Week 3: Basic Body Writing

Daily Targets

- **Day 15-16:** Learn the SEEP-T framework (Social, Economic, Environmental, Political, Technological). For 5 topics, list 3-4 dimensions each.
- **Day 17-18:** Write 4 body sections only (no introduction or conclusion). Each body must cover 3 dimensions with 1 example each. Keep each under 100 words.
- **Day 19-20:** Write 4 complete 150-word answers. Focus on the body — introduction and conclusion can be basic at this stage.
- **Day 21:** Weekly review. Compare your Week 3 answers with Week 1. Identify improvement areas.

Week 4: Evaluation and Conclusion

Day	Focus	Task
22	"While X, Y, Z" template	Write 4 evaluation paragraphs using the template. Each with a committee or report citation.
23	Way forward conclusions	Write 4 conclusions with specific policy recommendations.
24	Quote conclusions	

		Write 4 quote-based conclusions. Add 5 new quotes to your bank.
25	Synthesis practice	Write 4 conclusions that synthesize 3 distinct points into one insight.
26	Full IBEC answer	Write 2 complete 150-word answers using IBEC strictly. Self-evaluate using the IBEC checklist.
27	Peer review (optional)	Exchange answers with a peer. Evaluate each other's IBEC structure.
28	Week 4 review + Month 1 assessment	Review all 28 answers. Select your best 3 and worst 3. Analyze patterns.

End of Foundation Check: By Day 28, you should be able to write a 150-word IBEC answer in 12 minutes with: (a) a clear introduction, (b) 2-3 dimensional body paragraphs, (c) a separate evaluation sentence or two, and (d) a synthesized conclusion. If you cannot, repeat Week 3-4 before moving forward.

3. Weeks 5-8: Intermediate Phase

The Intermediate Phase introduces complexity — longer answers, multi-dimensional depth, diagram integration, and the crucial skill of evaluation. This is where the gap between average and good answers emerges.

Week 5: Scaling to 250-Word Answers

Understanding the 250-Word Structure

A 250-word answer is not simply a longer 150-word answer. It requires deeper analysis, more examples, a dedicated evaluation paragraph, and a nuanced conclusion. The IBEC allocation shifts: Introduction (25-35 words), Body (140-170 words), Evaluation (40-50 words), Conclusion (25-35 words).

Aspect	150-Word Answer	250-Word Answer
Introduction	1-2 sentences	2-3 sentences
Body dimensions	2 dimensions	3-4 dimensions
Examples per point	1 example total	2-3 examples total
Evaluation	1-2 sentences	3-5 sentences (paragraph)
Conclusion	1 sentence	2-3 sentences
Diagrams	Optional	Expected for appropriate topics

Daily Targets

- **Day 29-31:** Read 5 topper copies (250-word answers). Analyze how they expanded content compared to 150-word answers. Identify where they added depth.
- **Day 32-35:** Write 1 complete 250-word answer daily. Focus on covering 3-4 dimensions. Time: 18 minutes per answer.
- **Day 35:** Weekly review — how is the transition from 150 to 250 words going? Are you struggling to find enough content, or struggling to stay within limits?

Week 6: Multi-Dimensional Analysis Deep Dive

Advanced Dimensional Frameworks

Beyond the basic SEEP-T, learn to apply context-specific frameworks:

- **Governance questions:** Transparency, Accountability, Participation, Efficiency, Equity
- **Social questions:** Access, Inclusion, Empowerment, Identity, Justice
- **Economic questions:** Growth, Distribution, Stability, Sustainability, Resilience
- **Environmental questions:** Conservation, Mitigation, Adaptation, Governance, Equity
- **International relations:** Strategic, Economic, Diplomatic, Cultural, Security

Day	Focus Area	Questions to Practice
36-37	Governance/ Polity	"Examine the role of tribunals in India's judicial system." "Analyze the effectiveness of the Lokpal."
38-39	Economy	"Discuss the impact of cryptocurrency on India's financial system." "Evaluate PLI schemes."
40-41	Social Issues	"Analyze the intersection of caste and poverty in rural India." "Examine the male-female workforce gap."
42	Review + rewrite	Pick your weakest answer from the week and rewrite it with feedback.

Week 7: Diagram Integration

Types of Diagrams to Master

- **Flowcharts:** For processes, sequences, cause-effect chains. Practice: legislative process, monsoon mechanism, budget cycle.
- **Comparative tables:** For contrasting schemes, concepts, or policies. Practice: compare two government schemes across 4 parameters.
- **Cycles:** For feedback loops. Practice: poverty cycle, climate change feedback, population cycle.
- **Venn diagrams:** For overlapping concepts. Practice: separation of powers, SDG interlinkages, sustainable development.

- **Pyramids:** For hierarchies. Practice: judicial hierarchy, administrative structure, Maslow's hierarchy in ethics.

Daily Targets

- **Day 43-44:** Practice 3 diagrams daily from different subjects. Focus on clarity and labeling.
- **Day 45-47:** Write 3 answers with at least one diagram each. The diagram should add value — not just decoration.
- **Day 48-49:** Write 2 answers where the diagram is central to the explanation (e.g., explaining monsoon mechanism or institutional structure).

Diagram Rule: A diagram should save at least 30 words of explanation. If you can explain the same thing in fewer words without a diagram, skip the diagram. If the diagram conveys in 5 seconds what would take 50 words to explain, use it.

Week 8: Evaluation Mastery

Advanced Evaluation Techniques

- **Stakeholder analysis:** "The policy benefits X group but imposes costs on Y group."
- **Temporal analysis:** "Short-term gains vs long-term sustainability — the policy trades off X for Y."
- **Spatial analysis:** "Regional variation — southern states show X outcome while northern states show Y."
- **Comparative analysis:** "India's approach differs from China/Brazil/US because..."
- **Trade-off analysis:** "The efficiency-equity trade-off is evident in..."

Day	Evaluation Technique	Practice Task
50-51	Stakeholder analysis	Evaluate 3 policies from the perspective of different stakeholders
52-53	Temporal + Spatial	Evaluate 3 issues with short vs long term + regional variation
54-55	Comparative	

		Write 3 comparative evaluation paragraphs with global examples
56	Week 8 review + Month 2 assessment	Select your best 5 answers from Weeks 5-8. Identify patterns of strength and weakness.

Intermediate Phase Warning: Many students plateau at this stage — they can write structurally correct answers but lack depth. The solution is not to write more but to read more deeply. Spend 30 minutes daily reading high-quality sources (The Hindu editorial, EPW, PRS analysis) specifically to find content for your remaining practice weeks.

4. Weeks 9-12: Advanced Phase

The Advanced Phase is where you transition from practice to performance. Every answer must now be written under timed, exam-like conditions. The focus shifts from technique to speed, from individual answers to full papers, and from self-review to external feedback.

Week 9: Time Management

Time Allocation Per Paper

Paper	Total Marks	Total Time	Questions	Time per Q
GS 1, 2, 3, 4	250	180 min	20 (5+15+10+5 pattern varies)	~9 min/10-mark, ~12 min/15-mark
Essay	250	180 min	2 (1 essay)	90 min each
Optional Paper 1	250	180 min	Varies by subject	Adapt per question
Optional Paper 2	250	180 min	Varies by subject	Adapt per question

Time Management Drills

- **Day 57-58:** Write 5 answers (mixed 10 and 15 marks) in strict time — 7 min for 10-mark, 12 min for 15-mark. Use a stopwatch. Stop exactly when time ends, even mid-sentence.
- **Day 59-60:** 10-mark drill — write 5 answers in 7 minutes each with a 1-minute break between. This simulates the first hour of a paper.
- **Day 61-63:** Partial paper attempt — write 10 questions (5 of 10 marks + 5 of 15 marks) in 95 minutes total. This is half a GS paper.

Time Management Rule: In the exam, spend the first 5 minutes scanning all questions and selecting your best 20. Allocate time per question before you start writing. If a 15-mark question takes more than 12 minutes, leave space and move on. Return to incomplete answers only if you have time at the end.

Week 10: Full Paper Practice

Daily Targets

- **Day 64:** Attempt a full GS1 paper (250 marks, 180 min). Use a PYQ paper from 2022-2025.
- **Day 65:** Review your GS1 paper. Score each answer /10 or /15. Calculate total. Average score should be 55-65% by now.
- **Day 66:** Attempt a full GS2 paper under timed conditions.
- **Day 67:** Review GS2 paper. Identify which section (polity, governance, IR) needs improvement.
- **Day 68:** Attempt a full GS3 paper under timed conditions.
- **Day 69:** Review GS3 paper. Analyze diagram usage, data integration, evaluation depth.
- **Day 70:** Rest + reflection — compile lessons from all 3 papers. What is your weakest GS paper? Focus next week.

Week 11: Peer Review and Feedback Integration

Peer Review Protocol

1. Exchange 3 answers with a peer (or mentor, or online community).
2. For each answer, evaluate: Structure (IBEC), Content (accuracy, relevance), Analysis (depth, dimensions), Expression (clarity, flow).
3. Receive feedback without defensiveness. Ask clarifying questions.
4. Categorize feedback: Structural issues vs Content gaps vs Expression problems.
5. Rewrite all 3 answers incorporating the feedback.
6. Compare original vs rewrite. Quantify improvement (score /10).

Day	Activity	Output Expected
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71-72	Write 6 answers, send 3 for peer review	3 answers written + 3 sent for feedback
73-74	Review 3 peer answers + receive feedback on yours	3 peer reviews completed + 3 feedback received
75-76	Rewrite 3 answers based on feedback	3 rewritten answers + comparison analysis
77	Write 2 new answers applying feedback lessons	2 answers showing improvement from feedback

Week 12: Final Polish and Mock Tests

Mock Test Schedule

- **Day 78:** Mock Test GS1 (full paper, 180 min).
- **Day 79:** Mock Test GS2 (full paper, 180 min).
- **Day 80:** Mock Test GS3 (full paper, 180 min).
- **Day 81:** Mock Test GS4 (full paper, 180 min) + Essay (180 min).
- **Day 82:** Review all 4 mock tests. Calculate total marks. Identify last-minute corrections.
- **Day 83:** Targeted improvement — re-write answers from your weakest GS paper.
- **Day 84:** Light practice — write 5 introductions + 5 conclusions only. Review your entire 90-day journey.

Final Week Tip: In the last week, do not try to learn new content. Focus on: (a) practicing speed, (b) reviewing your common mistakes checklist, (c) memorizing your quote bank, data bank, and committee names. The preparation is done — now it's about execution.

5. Model Answers for Each Stage

Foundation Stage Model (150 words) — Week 3 Level

Question: "What is the significance of the Preamble of the Indian Constitution?" (10 marks)

Introduction (Factual): The Preamble to the Indian Constitution, adopted on 26 November 1949, declares India to be a Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, Democratic Republic and outlines the goals of Justice, Liberty, Equality, and Fraternity.

Body (Multi-dimensional): The Preamble serves three critical functions. First, it embodies the philosophical foundation of the Constitution — drawing from the Objectives Resolution (1946) and reflecting the ideals of the freedom struggle. Second, it acts as a key of interpretation — the Supreme Court in the Kesavananda Bharati case (1973) held that the Preamble is part of the Constitution and can be used to resolve ambiguities. Third, it reflects the evolving nature of the Constitution — the 42nd Amendment (1976) added 'Socialist', 'Secular', and 'Integrity' to the original text.

Evaluation (Balanced): While the Preamble is not enforceable in a court of law, its significance lies in guiding the interpretation of fundamental rights and directive principles. The SC has consistently used it to test the validity of constitutional amendments under the basic structure doctrine.

Conclusion (Synthesis): The Preamble is the soul of the Constitution — it encapsulates the vision of a just, inclusive, and democratic India, serving as both a promise to citizens and a compass for the state.

Intermediate Stage Model (250 words) — Week 7 Level

Question: "Discuss the role of the Public Distribution System in ensuring food security in India. What reforms are needed?" (15 marks)

Introduction (Contextual): With 35.5% of children under five stunted (NFHS-5) and India ranking 107th on the Global Hunger Index 2023, the Public

Distribution System (PDS) remains the cornerstone of India's food security architecture, reaching over 80 crore beneficiaries under the National Food Security Act (NFSA), 2013.

Body (Multi-dimensional with data):

Role in Food Security: PDS provides subsidized food grains (wheat at ₹2/kg, rice at ₹3/kg under NFSA) to eligible households, supplementing nutritional intake and stabilizing food prices. Economic Survey data shows PDS households consume 15-20% more calories than non-PDS poor households. It also serves as an income transfer mechanism — beneficiaries effectively receive a transfer equivalent to ₹500-700 per month.

Challenges: Despite its scale, PDS faces significant issues — leakage (NFSA estimates 15-20% grains diverted), exclusion errors (NITI Aayog estimates 10-15% eligible excluded), poor quality of grains, and limited coverage of nutritional items (no pulses, oil, or millets in most states).

Reforms and Innovations: Several states have demonstrated improvements — Odisha's digitized PDS reduced leakage to under 5%, Chhattisgarh's model expanded coverage to 90% of rural households, and Tamil Nadu's universal PDS eliminated exclusion errors. The integration of Aadhaar with POS machines (e-PoS) has improved transparency.

Evaluation (With committee references): The Shanta Kumar Committee (2015) recommended targeting subsidies to the poorest 40%, while the NITI Aayog's 2021 report advocated for cash transfers in urban areas and grain in rural areas. However, the "Right to Food" debate highlights that food security is not just about calories — nutritional security, dietary diversity, and women's intra-household equity must also be addressed.

Conclusion (Way forward with quote): As Amartya Sen observed, "Development is about freedom from deprivation." Reforming PDS — through digitization, inclusion of millets and pulses, and convergence with nutrition programs like POSHAN Abhiyan — is essential to transform food availability into genuine nutritional freedom for every Indian citizen.

Advanced Stage Model — Week 12 Level

Question: "India's federal structure has faced new challenges in the last decade. Critically examine the changing Centre-State relations." (15 marks)

Introduction (Conceptual + Contextual): Indian federalism, described by K.C. Wheare as "quasi-federal" and by Ambedkar as "unitary in spirit though federal in structure," has witnessed significant evolution in the last decade — marked by both cooperative and confrontational dynamics between the Centre and States across fiscal, legislative, and administrative domains.

Body (Structured with sub-headings):

Fiscal Federalism Challenges: The share of states in the divisible pool has declined — the 15th Finance Commission reduced states' share from 42% to 41%, while cesses and surcharges (which are not shared) now constitute 22% of gross tax revenue (up from 10% in 2011). The GST compensation cessation post-June 2022 has created fiscal stress for high-revenue-deficit states like Punjab, Kerala, and Rajasthan. The NITI Aayog's 2022 Health Index and Education Index rankings reveal growing inter-state disparities.

Legislative and Administrative Tensions: The use of Governor's powers — withholding bills (Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Punjab), delaying nominations, and recommending President's Rule in Maharashtra (2019) — has raised concerns about federal balance. The abrogation of Article 370 (2019) and the three farm laws (2020-21, later repealed) exemplify centralizing tendencies.

Cooperative Federalism Initiatives: Despite tensions, mechanisms like the GST Council (a rare example of cooperative federalism with voting power to states), Aspirational Districts Program, and state-specific zonal councils have fostered collaboration. The 15th Finance Commission's performance-based grants incentivize states toward reforms.

Evaluation (Multi-dimensional assessment): The Punchhi Commission (2010) recommendations on Governor appointments, the Sarkaria Commission's emphasis on consultation, and the recent SC judgment on state vs centre powers (Mohanlal vs State of MP, 2023) provide frameworks for recalibrating federal balance. While cooperative federalism rhetoric is strong, the operational reality reveals increasing centralization — especially in fiscal matters and law-and-order domains. The COVID-19 pandemic initially saw Centre-State collaboration (PM-CMs meetings, Group of Ministers), but subsequent policy centralization (vaccine procurement, lockdown decisions) created friction.

Conclusion (Synthesis + Way Forward): Indian federalism is not in crisis but in transition — from the "command-and-control" model of the early decades to a more negotiated, contested federal space. The way forward lies in institutionalizing inter-state councils, strengthening the Finance

Commission's role, ensuring Governor neutrality through a collegium appointment process, and reviving the spirit of cooperative federalism that Dr. Ambedkar envisioned — a union that is strong but not overbearing, united but not uniform.

6. Self-Evaluation Template

Self-evaluation is the most underutilized tool in answer writing practice. Most students write answers, feel they were "okay," and move on. Systematic self-evaluation transforms practice into improvement. Use the following template for every answer you write.

Parameter	Excellent (3)	Good (2)	Needs Work (1)	Score
Introduction relevance	Perfectly contextualized, right type chosen	Relevant but generic	Missing or off-topic	/3
Structure (IBEC)	Clear I, B, E, C sections	Structure present but blurry	No clear structure	/3
Multi-dimensional analysis	3+ dimensions with links	2 dimensions present	1 or no dimension	/3
Data/Examples	2+ specific data points or examples	1 example present	No examples or data	/3
Evaluation balance	Separate E section with evidence	Some balancing within body	One-sided, no evaluation	/3
Conclusion quality	Synthesis + way forward	Summary only	Missing or abrupt	/3
Word count	Within $\pm 10\%$ of limit	Within $\pm 20\%$	Way over or under	/3
Time management	Completed within time	Over by 1-2 min	Significantly overtime	/3
Total Score			/24	

Self-Evaluation Process:

Step 1: Immediately after writing, score yourself (hot evaluation — captures your intent).

Step 2: Wait 24 hours, then re-read and re-score (cold evaluation — more objective).

Step 3: Compare hot vs cold scores. If cold score is lower, identify what looked good at first but wasn't actually good.

Step 4: Rewrite the answer aiming for 20+/24.

7. Common Mistakes Checklist

Review this checklist before every practice session. After each answer, check off which mistakes you made. Over time, aim for zero checkmarks.

#	Mistake	Why It Hurts	Fix
1	No introduction or generic intro	Evaluator has no context	Use one of 4 intro types
2	Brain dump — writing everything known	No focus, no analysis	Answer only what is asked
3	No sub-headings	Wall of text, hard to follow	Use 2-3 sub-headings in body
4	One-dimensional analysis	Superficial answer	Apply SEEP-T or domain-specific framework
5	No data or examples	Opinions without evidence	Memorize 2-3 data points per topic
6	One-sided argument	Lacks critical thinking	Dedicate 1 paragraph to "however"
7	No conclusion or abrupt end	Answer feels incomplete	End with synthesis + insight
8	Exceeding word limit	Wastes time, nothing extra awarded	Practice timed writing
9	Poor handwriting	Evaluator cannot read	Practice 1 page daily for legibility
10	Irrelevant content	Shows lack of question analysis	Highlight keywords in question
11	No diagrams where helpful	Missed value addition	Plan 1 diagram per paper minimum
12	Repeating same points	Repetitive, wastes words	Each paragraph must add new angle

Top 3 Mistakes to Eliminate in Week 1-4: (1) No introduction — always write one. (2) Brain dumping — answer the question, not everything about the topic. (3) No conclusion — always end with synthesis.

Top 3 Mistakes to Eliminate in Week 5-8: (4) One-dimensional analysis — use frameworks. (5) No data — memorize key statistics. (6) One-sided answers — add evaluation.

Top 3 Mistakes to Eliminate in Week 9-12: (7) Time mismanagement — strict time per question. (8) No diagrams — plan them. (9) Poor handwriting — slow down for legibility.

8. How to Use Feedback Effectively

Feedback is only useful if you act on it. Most students collect feedback but never integrate it. Here is a systematic approach:

The Feedback Integration Cycle

1. **Receive feedback** — from peer, mentor, or self-evaluation template.
2. **Categorize** — is it structural (IBEC issues), content (knowledge gaps), or expression (clarity, flow)?
3. **Prioritize** — fix structural issues first, then content, then expression.
4. **Rewrite** — take the same question and rewrite the answer incorporating feedback.
5. **Compare** — original vs rewritten. Quantify improvement. What changed?
6. **Internalize** — add the lesson to your common mistakes checklist. Review it before the next practice session.

Feedback Sources and Reliability

Source	Reliability	Best For	Limitation
Self-evaluation (template)	Medium	Structure, word count, time	Cannot assess content accuracy
Peer review	Medium-High	Structure, flow, completeness	May not catch factual errors
Mentor/Teacher	High	Content accuracy, depth, strategy	Availability, cost
Online forums (r/UPSC, Telegram)	Low-Medium	Broad impressions, alternate approaches	Variable quality, no consistency
AI evaluation tools	Medium	Structure, grammar, expression	Cannot assess domain accuracy fully

Feedback Rule: If you receive the same feedback from 3 different sources, it is probably true. Prioritize fixing that issue. If feedback contradicts (e.g., "add more data" vs "too many numbers"), use your judgment based on the question's demand.

9. Weekly Answer Writing Schedule

This is your ideal weekly schedule once you reach Week 5 and beyond. Adjust based on your personal rhythm and other preparation commitments.

Day	Morning (1 hr)	Evening (30 min)	Total
Monday	Write 2 answers (1 × 150w + 1 × 250w)	Self-evaluate both answers using template	1.5 hrs
Tuesday	Rewrite 1 answer from Monday incorporating evaluation	Create 1 diagram relevant to the rewritten answer	1.5 hrs
Wednesday	Write 2 answers from a different GS paper	Evaluate + add data points to answer bank	1.5 hrs
Thursday	Peer review day — exchange 2 answers	Provide feedback on 2 peer answers	1.5 hrs
Friday	Rewrite 1 answer based on peer feedback	Practice 3 diagrams + memorize 5 data points	1.5 hrs
Saturday	Partial paper (10 questions, 95 min)	Evaluate paper, calculate score	2.5 hrs
Sunday	Review week's progress, update checklist	Rest / light reading of topper copies	1 hr

Weekly Tracking Template

Week	Answers Written	Avg Score (/24)	Improvement Area	Data Points Added	Diagrams Practiced
1					
2					
3					
4					

5

6

7

8

9

10

11

12

Final Encouragement: Answer writing is a skill, not a talent. It improves with deliberate practice. The difference between a 50% answer and a 75% answer is not genius — it is structure, evidence, and practice. Follow this plan, evaluate honestly, and rewrite relentlessly. By Day 90, you will be writing answers you could not have imagined on Day 1.

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